of the news from there. A platform where people exchange views' (Student, Female, Lahore): '*Yes, you can say that because nowadays whatever happens around the world it's all on Facebook in a second*' (Student, Female, Quetta).

There were, however, survey participants who were critical of the nature of the news that was shared on Facebook, highlighting how one needs to be wary of 'fake news'. In an international context, with Facebook's Cambridge Analytica scandal and the 2016 American elections in which the role of social media in spreading 'fake news' was highlighted, the danger of young people relying on such sites for information about their country and the world is highly problematic. The ease of access in an age when convenience has become a necessity, when information is available at the click of a button, that has made the problem particularly intractable. Students across the sample highlighted the importance of accessibility: '*With newspapers, going and reading a newspaper feels like a job. You have to take out time for that. Other mediums are constantly available with you (such as your phone/Facebook)*' (Focus Group, Private University[13]). This stance was also reflected by a student in Lahore: '*Because nowadays people find no time to read newspapers and watch news. They can easily see the current problems on social media*' (Focus Group, Private University[14]). While social media was considered a source of news, some argued that it went beyond newspapers, owing to its interactive user interface: '*Yes, because unlike news it's not one sided but all sorts of ideas, opinions and evidences are entertained which allows one to process and have their own point of view*' (Student, Female, Lahore); '*Well yes because people get to listen/analyse other people's perspectives and this is what makes them more politically active*' (Student, Male, Karachi).

However, the idea that such interaction and exchange of points of view is possible has repeatedly been questioned, with Facebook being defined as an 'echo chamber' (Allcott and Gentzkow 2017; Sanders 2016; Pariser 2011), or a medium following the logic of 'trench warfare' (Karlsen et al. 2017). For Karlsen et al. (2017) 'the architecture of the internet creates a particularly good environment for reinforcement through contradiction' (2017, p. 260). This is what they describe as 'trench warfare dynamics: people will interact and engage in debate with others who hold opposing political views, but this will only serve to strengthen their initial beliefs' (2017, pp. 260–1). Sanders (2016) argues that 'Facebook's News Feed, which is how most users see content through the app and site, is more likely to prominently display content based on a user's previous interests, and it also conforms to his or her political ideology.' The extent to which young people in our study engaged in online debate was also limited.